

Jenna Zeigen

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Work Experience

Notion - Software Engineer (L5) New York, NY • August 2024 - June 2026

- Spearheaded client performance initiatives targeting interaction latency across the Notion codebase, defining performance metrics and driving down component re-renders by 50%
- Acted as a global incident commander and trained others in the role, helping to shape the incident management program across the engineering organization

Slack New York, NY

Senior Staff Software Engineer February 2024 - July 2024

Staff Software Engineer August 2020 - January 2024

- Founded Slack's Client Performance Infrastructure team, leading programs that improved various dimensions of Slack's performance such as channel switch times, input delay, and component re-renders by up to 80%

Senior Software Engineer August 2018 - August 2020

Software Engineer January 2018 - August 2018

- Built the client-side infrastructure that powers autocomplete features across the product with 5 million daily active users, including the Quickswitcher, DM browser, @-mentioning, the emoji picker, and more

DigitalOcean New York, NY

Engineering Manager August 2015 - November 2017

- Lead and building teams of 2-5 engineers both across the web stack & specialized in frontend engineering
- Created team roadmap on a short- and medium-term basis based on needs of internal stakeholders
- Facilitated team members' growth through regular feedback, goal-setting in 1:1s, and quarterly reviews

Software Engineer, Team Lead February 2015 - August 2015

- Drove efforts to convert DigitalOcean's cloud control panel to Ember
- Worked with the design team to create a UI pattern library for use in the control panel and other applications
- Helped build out the initial team of front-end engineers
- Lead efforts to create an Engineering Code of Conduct still in use within the organization

Bitly - Software Engineer New York, NY • September 2013 - January 2015

- Contributed to the redesign & unification of Bitly's products to enhance link management & audience insights
- Spearheaded project to start using Browserify to clean up our dependency management story
- Introduced front-end performance monitoring & worked to optimize the application based on collected data

#waywire - Software Engineer New York, NY • February 2013 - August 2013

- Wrote JavaScript, CoffeeScript, and Ruby to drive the interactivity and functionality of the site
- Redesigned the system for identifying embedded videos and wiring them to the network

Patents

Reducing Transmissions by Suggesting Digital Content for Display in a Group-Based Communication Interface

Issued Oct 13, 2020 • US 10805386

Optimizing application performance with machine learning

Issued April 4, 2023 • US 11620173

User account telemetry within a communication platform

Issued February 13, 2024 • US 11902041

Education

Brown University - Sc.B. in Cognitive Science, with honors

Providence, RI • 2008 - 2012

Recurse Center - Participant

Brooklyn, NY • October 2012 - December 2012

- Programmed novel, in-depth projects exploring various programming languages and technologies
- Created full-stack web applications, NLP and image processing scripts in JavaScript and Python
- Discussed and reviewed projects with and providing feedback to other participants and facilitators

Community Involvement

Organizer - New York UX Speed and Web Performance Meetup

Conference Speaker

- Node.JS Interactive @ RenderATL 2026: "Client Performance in the Age of AI"
- JSConf NA 2025: "Several Components are Rendering: Client Performance at Scale"
- Lead Dev NYC 2024: "Several Components are Rendering: Client Performance at Slack-Scale"
- QCon NYC 2023: "Several Components are Rendering: Client Performance at Slack-Scale"
- JSConf Hawaii 2020: "Parsing Parsers"
- #perfmatters 2019: "Fantastic Frontend Performance Tricks and Why We Do Them"
- QCon SF 2018: "Fantastic Frontend Performance Tricks and Why We Do Them"
- Node+JS Interactive 2018: "From Parentheses to Perception"
- RevolutionConf 2018: "Fantastic Frontend Performance Tricks and Why We Do Them"
- NationJS 2017: "The Browser and the Brain"
- Node Interactive North America 2017: "On How Your Brain Is Conspiring Against You Making Good Software"
- RevolutionConf 2017: "On How Your Brain Is Conspiring Against You Making Good Software"
- Front-Trends 2017: "On How Your Brain Is Conspiring Against You Making Good Software"
- JSConf Iceland 2016: "On How Your Brain Is Conspiring Against You Making Good Software"
- ForwardJS 5: "On How Your Brain Is Conspiring Against You Making Good Software" (Keynote)
- PolyConf 2016: "The Linguistic Relativity of Programming Languages"
- DinosaurJS 2016: "Server Farm to Table (or, how the Internet Works)"
- RejectJS 2015: "What if your brain were ~*literally*~ JavaScript"
- TXJS 2015: "What if your brain were ~*literally*~ JavaScript"
- EmpireJS 2015: "The Linguistic Relativity of Programming Languages"
- JSConf EU 2014: "The Linguistic Relativity of Programming Languages"